

The situla of Psammetik son of Sheshonk at the Egyptian Museum
(Cairo CG 3447)

إناء سيتولا لبسماتيك بن شاشنق بالمتحف المصري (القاهرة، ك: 3447)

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Abstract:

This article is a publication of the situla of Psammetik, son of Sheshonk, at the Egyptian Museum in Cairo (CG 3447), dating between the late Twenty-Sixth Dynasty to the very beginning of the Thirtieth Dynasty. It follows the characteristic decorative program of Late Period situlae and contributes to our understanding of religious and funerary rituals and the role of the Theban clergy during the Late and Ptolemaic Periods. In addition, it provides evidence contributing to the reconstruction of the genealogy of a Theban family of the Late Period whose members are attested on other monuments.

The situla, its type, decoration and inscriptions are studied, while great efforts and attempts are made to suggest a firmer dating and provenance. The study relies on stylistic features, characteristics of the inscription and comparison to datable parallels. In addition, it also reconstructs the owner's family up to six generations connecting him to other inscribed monuments belonging to the same family.

Keywords: Psammetik, Situla, Cool-water offering, Genealogy, Thebes, Late Period, the Egyptian Museum in Cairo

الملخص:

هذا المقال نشر لإناء سيتولا للكهان بسماتيك، بن شاشنق، بالمتحف المصري بالقاهرة (ك: 3447)، يُورخ بين الأسرة السادسة والعشرين حتى بداية الأسرة الثلاثين. الإناء يتبع خصائص برنامج الزخارف لسيتولا العصر المتأخر، ويساهم في فهم الطقوس الدينية والجنائزية ودور اللاهوت الطبيي خلال العصرين المتأخر والبطلمي. بالإضافة لذلك، فهو يقدم أدلة تساهم في إعادة بناء نسب إحدى العائلات الطيبية خلال العصور المتأخرة، والتي ثبت أفرادها على آثار أخرى. تم دراسة إناء السيتولا من حيث النمط، الزخارف، والنصوص؛ فيما بذلت الجهود لإعادة تأريخه بشكل دقيق وتحديد مصدره. الدراسة استندت على السمات الفنية والسمات الكتابية للنص مع مقارنته بأمثلة من نفس الفترة الزمنية. بالإضافة لذلك، فإن الدراسة قامت بإعادة بناء نسب العائلة حتى ست أجيال من خلال ربط صاحب السيتولا بآثار أخرى تخص أفراد العائلة نفسها.

الكلمات الدالة: بسماتيك، سيتولا، صيغة التقديم للماء البارد، الأنساب، طيبة، العصر المتأخر، المتحف المصري بالقاهرة.

1. Introduction

The Egyptian Museum in Cairo holds a collection of situlae from the Late and Ptolemaic Periods.¹ Most of them are made of bronze using hammering while few are made by casting techniques. These ritual vessels, which represent different types and a diversity of representations on the exterior surface,² are mostly associated with funerary contexts. The function of situlae is strongly suggested by the themes of

¹ Bissing, F. W., *Metallgefäße, Catalogue général des antiquités égyptiennes du Musée du Caire (Nos. 3426–3587)*, Vienna: Imprimerie Adolf Holzhausen, 1902, 6-30.

² Lichtheim discussed the types and functions of situlae: Lichtheim, M., "Situla No. 11395 and Some Remarks on Egyptian Situlae," *JNES* 6/3, 1947, 169–179.

offering scenes, adorning the surface, rendered for the owner's benefit in the afterlife.³ However, some of them are connected with the religious service at the temple,⁴ which are emphasized either from the archaeological contexts, otherwise the divine representations on the surface.⁵ Cairo CG 3447 represents a particularly significant example. It stands out not only because of its distinctive type and elaborate decorative program, but also because it incorporates the libation formula from Pyramid Texts Spell 32. Furthermore, the object is notable for the complexity of its provenance and debated date. Additionally, it contributes to reconstructing the genealogy of a Theban priestly family, which is securely documented on a few other monuments.

The situla of Priest of Wenennefer and Priest of Montu in Thebes, Psammetik (hence after Psammetik the Elder), son of Sheshonk the Elder,⁶ is kept at the Egyptian Museum in Cairo (JE 15127, CG 3447 and SR.2-13418). It is finely crafted in bronze using the hammering technique and measures 22cm in height and 7.7cm in diameter (fig. 1). Its provenance remains uncertain, with scholarly debate as to whether it originated from Sheikh Abd el-Qurna in Thebes or from Zagazig in the Delta.⁷ It stands as an excellent example for situlae type I, typically associated with funerary contexts, in Lichtheim's classification of situlae.⁸ Both the formal qualities and decorative program of the vessel are consistent with Lichtheim's Type I, a typology defined by centrally arranged offering scenes framed by bands of inscription. The situla under discussion features a characteristic ovoid body with a molded rim, two suspension loops, a large arched handle, and a rounded base supported by small pointed feet. The exterior bears a sole engraved offering scene accompanied by a hieroglyphic inscription (figs. 1–3).

This paper re-examines situla (CG 3447) within the broader typology of Late Period ritual situlae, with a particular focus on three interrelated issues: its provenance,

³ In addition to CG 3447, also CG 3453, a bronze situla of Irtharerau, and CG 3460 of Pedemonkh, CG 3444 (JE 32098 = SR.2-12905) from Abydos, and Cairo JE 33468 from Dra Abu el-Naga. PM IV, 34A; V 61, 115; Bissing, *Metallgefässe*, 7-10, 19-20, and 23.

⁴ For instance see Cairo JE 50940 (SR.4-13061), a bronze situla dedicated by Ramosi, region of Amenophis IV, New Kingdom, El-Amarna. PM IV 165A; Pendlebury, J.D.S., *City of Akhenaton III*, (London, 1936), pl. lx [7], fig. 25. Other late and Ptolemaic Period examples from Saqqara and Sais, including situlae (Cairo JE 91475; JE 91354; JE 91356; JE 91134; JE 91121). PM III², 825A; IV 34A; Green, I., *The Temple Furniture from the Sacred Animal Necropolis at North Saqqâra 1964–1976*, Excavation Memoir 53, London: Egypt Exploration Society, 1987, nos. 163, 166, 178, 181, 189, and figs. 99, 107-109, 115-116; Bissing, *Metallgefässe*, 6-30.

⁵ Examples of these vessels are often showing decorative program for offerings to the temple's gods by the owner. For instance Cairo CG 3462, 3463, 3464, and CG 3465 (Bissing, *Metallgefässe*, 24-27), Cleveland Museum 1932.32, British Museum (EA 38212 and 38214), and St. Petersburg Museum (DV-2345; situlae of Pakharkhonsu).

⁶ PM IV, 34A; Mariette, A., *Album du Musée de Boulaq: comprenant quarante planches photographiées par MM. Délié et Béchard; avec un texte explicatif*, Cairo: Mourès, 1871 on pl. 21; Bissing, *Metallgefässe*, 9-10.

⁷ Bissing, *Metallgefässe*, 9-10.

⁸ Lichtheim, *Situla No. 11395 and Some Remarks on Egyptian Situlae*, 169, and Pl. IV, no.11.

attributed dating, and the genealogy of its owner. Although its inscriptions were previously transcribed in the *Catalogue Général* of the Egyptian Museum,⁹ key aspects remain uncertain—most notably its provenance and the identification of its owner and familial connections. The research question, therefore, is: To what extent can a comprehensive analysis of the iconography, inscriptions, and offices of Psammetik the Elder, son of Sheshonk the Elder, contribute to determine the situla's provenance and refining its dating?

2. Description

A cylinder shaped situla belonging to the priest Psammetik the Elder, son of Sheshonk the Elder, represents a model that is regularly to be dated to the Late and Ptolemaic periods.¹⁰ The vessel is made in egg-shaped form with a round base ending in a pointed foot. The base is broader than the upper part of the situla. The rim is carefully molded, and two suspension loops are affixed near the top, set in opposite position to support a large, arched handle (figs. 1-2). This carefully manufactured design represents a typical example of Lichtheim's Type I situlae, in which the vessel is in this particular case designated with pointed foot in its round base.¹¹ The pointed foot is seen in other examples at the Egyptian Museum including CG 3453 from Abydos,¹² and also with other types such as situlae Cairo CG 3457 and CG 3460, both came also from Abydos. The design noticeably applies the characteristic of the Late and Ptolemaic situlae in both form and decorative program.¹³

The exterior's surface is adorned with a very typical scene that appears on many of the Late Period situlae. It represents common offerings for the deceased/owner accompanied by a hieroglyphic inscription that often stating the offering formula, titular of the owner/deceased, and familial ties.¹⁴ The rest of the surface carefully remains polished without any decorations (figs. 1–4). It is worth noting that the offerings scene which adorning the vessel's exterior emphasizes the funerary function of such ritual objects. The deceased is usually seated receiving the cool-water libation in a ritual that occurs repeatedly where the deceased's son performs the ritual. The whole scene is framed with an incised line from the four sides, while its top adorned by a band representing the starry sky that usually appears in this composition on the surface of situlae resembling the divine realm, e.g. situlae Cairo CG 3448 and CG 3450.

⁹ Bissing, *Metallgefässe*, 9-10.

¹⁰ PM IV, 34A; Mariette, *Album du Musée*, pl. 21; Bissing, *Metallgefässe*, 9-10. PM noted that it is dated to Ptolemaic or Roman Period.

¹¹ Lichtheim, *Situla No. 11395 and Some Remarks on Egyptian Situlae*, Pl. IV, no.11.

¹² Bissing, *Metallgefässe*, 19-20.

¹³ For parallels from the late and Ptolemaic periods, see Situla (British Museum EA 38212) from Thebes, Thirtieth Dynasty; and situla of Nesmin son of Psammetik (Louvre N 908 D). Coulon, L. *Les voies ouvertes à l'égyptologie*, Paris: Collège de France, 2024, 37-39, fig. 1.

¹⁴ For similar presentation with the same theme of the offering formula and scene, compare Cairo CG 3448 and 3450; and Louvre N 908 D and Louvre E 12658; and the British Museum EA 83212, EA 83214.

At the left side of the scene, the owner, Psammetik the Elder, receives the libation of cool water “*kbhw*” and incense from a priest, normally the son, who stands before him, on the opposite side of the scene, performing the ritual act. The two figures are separated by an inscription composed of thirteen columns started from left to right (figs. 1-2). The two depicted figures that are featured in the scenes are described as follows.

The main figure, on the left, the receiver, Psammetik the Elder, receives the rituals. He sits on a lion-legged chair with a backrest decorated by a stylized lotus motif, resting on a mat where an unguent jar is also placed. He is depicted with the long hear with a perfume cone atop his head wearing an elaborated leopard skin¹⁵ decorated with rosettes and short kilt. His left hand is stretched to the table placed before him, while his right hand grasps an emblematic symbol. A simple offering table is placed before him, where two wine jars are placed under the table (fig. 1-2).

The second figure, on the right, the presenter, the son, acts the priest who performs cool-water libation and incense before the deceased (fig. 4). He is shown performing the ritual of libation and burning incense. He holds a censer—likely proper equipment for incense during the Late Period—in his left hand, and pours water from a ewer with his right hand over an offering table shaped as an *htp*-sign. The table is loaded with two round loaves of bread. Unlike his father, he is shown bald-headed and wears a broad, pleated kilt fastened securely at the waist (fig. 3).

3. Inscriptions

The situla is engraved with 13 columns of hieroglyphic inscriptions in, centered between the two figures as part of the offering scene. The inscription contains the standard offering formula copied from Pyramid Text PT 32 (see Discussion), together with the titles and the genealogy of the owner. The title of the ritual is placed before the presenter, Sheshonk the Younger, in a short column, just under column (9). It reads:

↓  “*irt sntr*” “*Making censing*”

The main inscription read from left to right as follows:

¹⁵ About the Leopard skin mantel as a priestly vest sees. Hallmann, A., “A Change or a Continuation of Style? Observations on the Pelt Vestment in the Late Period Karnak Cachette Sculptures” in Laurent Coulon, *La Cachetter de Karnak: Nouvelles perspectives sur les découvertes de Geoges Legrain* (2016), 365-381.

(13) *nb(.t) pr ir.t-irw*

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of the god's Seals, *iry-ps*^(e) Priest from the third phyla (and Priest of) Montu, lord of Thebes (6) (Priest) in his month, (of) Khonsu-in-Thebes-Neferhotep from the first phyla, Psammetik, justified, ^(f) son of likewise^(g) (7) Sheshonk born to Mistress of the house and the Songstress of Amunre, Irtyru, ^(h) justified (8) O Horus, has gone forth ^(l) to your son, has gone forth ⁽ⁱ⁾ to Horus. I have come and I bring (to you) the Eye of Horus. (9) Psammetik is his (literally: her) son's name ^(k); may he live. (This is) made by (10) God's Father and Priest of Wenennefer, Sheshonk (11) son of likewise (12) Psammetik, born to (13) Mistress of the house, Irtyru.

3.1 Comment

(a). the sign intended for *mdw* has been incorrectly rendered with the two-leaf sign. In his published transcription, Bissing also miscopied the sign, recording it as: . ¹⁶

(b). '*ipn*, *these*'¹⁷ a masculine plural demonstrative pronoun, which is attested frequently from the *Pyramid Texts* onward. It represents the Old Egyptian plural form corresponding to the later masculine demonstrative *pn*, and typically follows the noun it modifies. These older plural forms continue to appear occasionally in Middle Egyptian, especially in texts of a religious or ritual character.¹⁸

(c). the determinative  (R18E),¹⁹ in the name of Abydos, is followed by a long narrow sign in the form of a stake, which is miswritten in this instance. The glyph  is an object with a cylindrical body rounded off at the top with two plumes and a bandage wrapped around it trails.²⁰ '*zbd*' or '*zbt*,' is reliquary for the head of Osiris at Abydos, and thus Osiris is frequently followed with his epithet as foremost of Abydos.²¹ Thus, this sign is read '*Abydos*' and frequently occurs with its variants like    . ²²

(d). Column (4) repeats the cool-water formula first introduced in column (1), a quotation from PT spell 32, which resumes in column (8) after the listing of Psammetik the Elder's titles.

¹⁶ Bissing, *Metallgefässe*, 10.

¹⁷ Wb I, 69.13. It occurred frequently in the *Pyramid Texts*, e.g. Pyr.22-24.

¹⁸ Allen, J. P., *Middle Egyptian*, Second edition, Cambridge, 2010, 54-55; Kupreyev, M., *Demonstrative pronouns and articles in Egyptian and Coptic: emergence and development* (Ph.D. Thesis), Berlin, 2020, 54.

¹⁹ Gardiner, A., Sign List, (sign R17); Wilson, P., *A Ptolemaic Lexikon: A Lexicographical Study of the Texts in the Temple of Edfu*, OLA 78, Leuven: Peeters 1997, 6.

²⁰ Wilson, *A Ptolemaic Lexikon*, 6; Chassinat, É., (1968), *Le mystère d'Osiris au mois de Khoiak*, Fascicule II, Cairo: IFAO, 1968, 589-90.

²¹ Wilson, *A Ptolemaic Lexikon*, 6; Edfu I, 172.4; Meeks D., (1982), *Année lexicographique: Égypte ancienne*, Paris: Imprimerie la Marguerite, 1982, 77.0024.

²² Wb I, 9.1.

(e). *iri ps*, a priestly title occurred with several writings from the Late Periods.²³ It is attested here with an abnormal determinative , which occurred also on the statue of Pakharkhonsu son of Psammetik (Cairo JE 38016) from the Twenty-Sixth Dynasty.²⁴ It occurred with several variations,²⁵ e.g., ,²⁶ ,²⁷ ,²⁸ ,²⁹ ,³⁰ and is often determined with  (vars. , , ).³¹

(f). ‘*mꜣꜥ-hrw, justified*’ is repeatedly written with two “ *mꜣꜥ*”-sign (Aa11) in the current inscriptions instead of its regular form.

(g). *mi-nn* “*likewise/ the like-titled*,”³² a common formula occurred frequently in the genealogical inscriptions of the Late and Ptolemaic Period. It is used to avoid repeating the titles which inherited from the father to the son.

(h). *Ir.t-ir.w, Irtyru*, a female name occurs twice in identical orthography within the inscription, referring to the mother and the wife of Psammetik the Elder. This name occurred frequently during the Late and Ptolemaic Periods.³³

(l). the proposition ‘ *m*’ after ‘*Ir.w*’ is written in reverses, and it is a miswriting as it doesn’t belong to the original text.

(i). in the writing *pr.w xr Ir*, the scribe has mistakenly interchanged the letters *h* and *r*, resulting in an inverted sequence. It appears that the scribe became confused in this part of the inscription; his intended wording was likely as follows:

²³ It is well attested on several monuments, including Cairo CG 3447, 36714, JE 37139, JE 37142, JE 37215, JE 37847, and JE 38016. Jansen-Winkeln, *Biographische und religiöse Inschriften der Spätzeit*, I, 53, 55; Birk, R., *Türöffner des Himmels: Prosopographische Studien zur thebanischen Hohepriesterschaft der Ptolemäerzeit* (Ägyptologische Abhandlungen 76), Wiesbaden: Harrassowitz, 2020, 487-488, 496, 500, 503, 507, 511-512.

²⁴ Selim H., “The naophorous statue JE 38016 in the Cairo museum,” *MDAIK* 56, 2000, 361-369.

²⁵ Jansen-Winkeln, *Biographische und religiöse Inschriften der Spätzeit*, I, 56(7).

²⁶ On statute Cairo JE 37141.

²⁷ On statute Cairo JE 37363.

²⁸ On statute Cairo JE 37173.

²⁹ On statute Cairo JE 37847.

³⁰ On statute Cairo JE 38061.

³¹ Jansen-Winkeln, *Biographische und religiöse Inschriften der Spätzeit*, I, 56(7).

³² Rashed, M.G., “The block statue of Djedhor son of Tjanefer [JE 37200],” *JARCE* 55, 2019, 124; Selim, H., “Three unpublished Late Period statues,” *SAK* 32, 2004, 369; El-Sayed, R., “Deux statues inédites du Musée du Caire,” *BIFAO* 84, 1984, 148.

³³ PN I, 42.10; Birk, *Türöffner des Himmels*, 489, 493. E.g. on the offering tables Cairo CG 23155, and statue Hannover (August Kestner Museum Inv. S.0366), and the situla London (BM EA 38212).

(k). the suffix pronoun (*s*) her is a miswriting and it should be for the 3rd person singular masculine.

4. Discussion

This section examines three key aspects of the present situla: the owner's name, titles, and family connections; the writing characteristics; and, finally, the question of its provenance and dating.

4.1 The Owner's Name and Titles, and Familial Connections

The inscription records the names and titles of the owner, together with those of his parents, wife, and son. The personal names appearing in the inscription are well attested during the Late and Ptolemaic periods. The owner's name, Psammetik the Elder (*Psmṯk*),³⁴ occurs frequently in Late Period inscriptions. His son bears the name Sheshonk (*ššnḳ*),³⁵ evidently named after his grandfather, while both his mother and his wife share the same name, Irtyru (*ir.t-ir.w*).

The God's Father, Psammetik the Elder held several priestly and administrative offices at Karnak in the service of the Theban gods Wenennefer, Montu, and Khonsu-in-Thebes-Neferhotep, sharing these titles with both his father and his son. His principal titles recorded as follows:

1. *hm-ntr Wn, Priest of Wenennefer*

This title associates Psammetik the Elder—together with his father and son—with the priestly service of Wenennefer, a local Theban manifestation of Osiris.³⁶ The title is frequently attested during the Late Period.³⁷ According to Youotte, it is already attested in Thebes from the Twenty-Second Dynasty onward and appears

³⁴ This name appears frequently during the Late and Ptolemaic Periods. PN I, 136 (8), e.g. Stelae Cairo CG 22046; 22055; 22075. It is also found in various compound name formations. PN I, 136(9-22)-137(1-3).

³⁵ PN I, 330 (6).

³⁶ The manifestation of this god is well attested from New Kingdom onwards. Wb I, 311.1; LGG II, 374-376.

³⁷ Yoyotte, J., “Prêtres et sanctuaires du nome héliopolite à la basse époque,” *BIFAO* 54, 1954, 102-103. E.g. Bn-w-thi-@r, on his statue Cairo JE 36983 from the region of Nectanebo I, and also the priest Nespanejdou (Cairo JE 36985). Birk, *Türöffner des Himmels*, 497-499; Jansen-Winkel, K., *Biographische und religiöse Inschriften der Spätzeit aus dem Ägyptischen Museum Kairo* (Ägyptologische Abhandlungen 45), vol. I, Wiesbaden, 2001, 5 (a, 1); 8 (c, e, 1); 11(a,3; b,1); 12 (c,2); 27 (b,2; d, 1); 39 (2); 55 (3); 169, 173 (5), and 169-174; II, 403.

to have referred to temporary administrative duties within the temple of Amun-Re at Karnak.³⁸

2. *shꜣw ḥtm.w-nṯr, Scribe of the Divine Seals*³⁹

This title commonly appears in its abbreviated form, though longer formulations are also attested. These include references to specific deities such as “*Scribe of the Divine Seals of Amun*,”⁴⁰ as well as institutional variants, for example “*Scribe of the Treasury of the Temple of Amun*.”⁴¹

3. *iri ps, the Baker of the Temple*

This title is frequently attested during the Late and Ptolemaic Periods.⁴² It has generally been interpreted as “*cooker*” or “*baker of the temple*,” or as a related provisioning function.⁴³ The title may refer to a priest responsible for supervising the bakery and its offerings, and its holders were often entrusted with wider administrative and service-related duties in addition to their priestly roles. It commonly appears in association with the titles ‘*Iri ꜥft, imi-st.t-ꜥ/ imi-s.t-rd*’.⁴⁴

4. *ḥr sꜣ H-nw n Mnṯw nb Wꜣs.t, (Priest) from the third phyla (and priest of) Montu, lord of Thebes*

This is a proper title in the Theban clergy indicating his priestly office in the service of Montu lord of Thebes; a god whom his assumed descendants also served in Thebes.

5. *(ḥm-nṯr) imi ꜣbd.f, (Priest of the god) in his month,*

This title identifies its holder as a priest serving the god during his designated monthly service rotation.

6. *imi ꜣbd.f Hnsw-m-Wꜣst-Nfr-ḥtp ḥr sꜣ tpy, (Priest) in his month of Khonsu-in-Thebes-Neferhotep from the first phyla*

³⁸ Yoyotte, J., “Prêtres et sanctuaires du nome héliopolite à la basse époque,” *BIFAO* 54, 102-103.

³⁹ Al-Ayedi, A.R., *Index of Egyptian Administrative, Religious and Military Titles of the New Kingdom*, Ismailia, 2006, 570, no.1911.

⁴⁰ Al-Ayedi, *Index*, 570, no.1912.

⁴¹ Al-Ayedi, *Index*, 570, no.1913.

⁴² It is first attested in the Twenty-sixth Dynasty inscriptions and is widespread during the Late Periods. Abdelrahman, *The situla of Pa-di-Amun-neb-nesut-tawy*, 1-23; Buhl, M., *The Late Egyptian Anthropoid Stone Sarcophagi*, Copenhagen, 1959, 64, Fig.26, pl. III-IV; Selim, *The naophorous statue JE 38016*, 366, No. C.

⁴³ It is derived from the *psy* “*cooker*” which is attested as early as the Middle Kingdom. WB I, 552.12-14; Lesko, *Dictionary I*, 181.

⁴⁴ The title is often found in association with *Iri ꜥft* and *Imi-s.t-ꜥ/Imi-s.t-rd*. It is well attested on several monuments, including Cairo CG 3447, 36714, JE 37139, JE 37142, JE 37215, JE 37847, and JE 38016. Jansen-Winkel, *Biographische und religiöse Inschriften der Spätzeit*, I, 53, 55; Birk, *Türöffner des Himmels*, 487-488, 496, 500, 503, 507, 511-512.

Khonsu-in-Thebes-Neferhotep is a Theban manifestation of Khonsu at Karnak.⁴⁵ The Priest usually serves the god during his designated monthly service rotation (*imi ȓbd.f*), specifically within the first phyle (*hr sȓ tpy*) in Psammetik the Elder's case. Phyle-based priestly organization is well attested in the Theban temples throughout the Late and Ptolemaic Periods.

The titles associated with Psammetik the Elder, his father, and his son suggest that their activity was restricted to mid-level priestly and administrative offices exclusively within the Karnak Temple, as their documented titles reveal no affiliations with other Theban cult centers.

In addition to the titles of Psammetik the Elder, the inscription records his genealogy by naming his parent, wife, and son. This information constitutes a valuable milestone for reconstructing the genealogy of the family (table 1 and 3). However, it is not easy to extend the family tree or to gain a deeper understanding of their careers, since neither Psammetik the Elder nor any of his relatives is reliably attested on any other monuments. Due to the lack of clear correspondence, efforts to integrate this family within the broader Theban priesthood during the Late Period have been hindered.

A further complication lies in the frequency of the names recorded on the situla. Personal names such as Psammetik, Sheshonk, and Irtyru were widely used during the Late and Ptolemaic Periods, making it problematic to identify these particular individuals on any other inscribed monuments. This challenge is particularly acute when attempting to identify the female members of the family as being an element of great importance for genealogical reconstructions⁴⁶. Although the inscription preserves the names of owner's wife and mother, the recurrence of these names elsewhere in the record prevents a confident identification.

Despite these limitations, some potential connections may be suggested. By comparing the priestly titles borne by Psammetik the Elder, his father, and his son with those of other known figures of the period, it is possible to propose familial or institutional links within the Theban priesthood.⁴⁷ Such an approach, while necessarily cautious, opens the door for identifying broader networks of familial connections and

⁴⁵ Klotz, D., *The Theban Cult of Chonsu the Child in the Ptolemaic Period*, in Thiers (ed.), *Documents du Théologies Thébaines Tardives (D3t 1)*, Montpellier 2001, 97; Thiers, Chr., "Une porte de Ptolémée Évergète II consacrée à Khonsou-qui-fixe-le-sort", *Karnak* 11, 2003, 587-602; Traunecker, Cl., "La chapelle de Khonsou du mur d'enceinte et les travaux d'Alexandre", *Karnak* 8, 1987, 347-354.

⁴⁶ Since personal names were widely repeated during this period, the attestations of female partners' names, included in genealogical records, provide a more reliable tool for establishing or refuting potential familial ties. Compare for instance the approach made by Daniel to reconstruct a Ptolemaic Egypt family. Potter, D. M., "The Statue of a Sistrum-player in Montrose and Her Position in an Early Ptolemaic Theban Priestly Family," *JEA* 107, 249-263.

⁴⁷ Birk listed the familial connections as attested on Late and Ptolemaic Period inscribed monuments. Birk, *Türöffner des Himmels*, 298-300; 479-521.

service in Karnak during the Thirtieth Dynasty. In a brief comparison, one can conclude such comparative prosopography note highlighting the complexity of the problem. Several priests named Psammetik or Sheshonk are attested in the Late and Ptolemaic periods, some serving as Priest of Amun in Karnak, Montu lord of Thebes, Khonsu in Thebes, and Neferhotep, or holding offices linked with Amun and the temple of Karnak. Some of whom bore titles similar to those on the present situla, while others extend their offices at other cult centers.⁴⁸

These overlaps highlight the difficulty of establishing direct genealogical connections but nevertheless suggest that Psammetik the Elder's family belonged to the wider circle of Theban priestly families active in the late fourth century BCE. Further comparative work with the Karnak Cachette corpus may help refine these connections.

In this context, the author has examined possible connections with other individuals who bore the same names and held comparable titles. A particularly promising parallel is found in the family of Nesmin, son of Psammetik (hence after Psammetik the Younger), who served as Priest of Amun, Montu, Khonsu, and Neferhotep at Karnak. This family held a prominent position within the Theban clergy during the Late Period specifically under the Thirtieth Dynasty. The genealogy of this family can be reconstructed from a substantial group of monuments (Cairo JE 36714; JE 36715; JE 37140; JE 37250; JE 37193).⁴⁹ On this basis, it may be suggested that Psammetik the Elder, the owner of the present situla, represents an earlier generation of the same family—possibly the father of Nesmin, son of Psammetik the Younger, the well-attested priest associated with situla Louvre (N 908 D) and the statues Cairo JE 36714 and JE 37250, or alternatively his great-grandfather.⁵⁰ The inscription on the situla of Psammetik the Elder appears to record three generations, which likely represent the earliest known members of this extended family. Psammetik the Younger, the father of Nesmin, would thus constitute the fourth generation within this reconstructed genealogical sequence.

According to this suggestion, the first three generations of the family are represented solely by the situla under discussion (Cairo CG 3447; see Tables 1 and 3). This reconstruction, however, rests entirely on this single attestation, as no additional monuments can presently be associated with these early generations. The earliest generation includes Sheshonk the Elder, described with the phrase “*mī nn, likewise,*” indicating that he held the same titles as his son, Psammetik the Elder. The latter's

⁴⁸ For the attestations and titles of many of these individuals see: Birk, *Türöffner des Himmels*, 479-521. Specifically, 495, 503 (Cairo JE 37215 and JE 36714, statues of Nesmin which record his ancestors).

⁴⁹ Rashed, *The Theophorous Statue of Pedeamunnebnesttaui*, *JARCE* 61/1 (2026), 77–102; Birk, *Türöffner des Himmels*, 208 note 318, 241 note 55; Coulon, *Les voies ouvertes à l'égyptologie*, 37-39.

⁵⁰ It worth noting that the father and grandfather of Nesmin are named as Psammetik and Sheshonk. According to the current suggestion Psammetik the Elder (Cairo CG 3447), is identified with Psammetik, the father of Nesmin, otherwise he is his great-grandfather. Compare the genealogical sequence of the family on both situla Cairo CG 3447 and statue Cairo JE 37215. Birk, *Türöffner des Himmels*, 503.

wife, Irtyru I, is also named in the inscription and is designated “*Lady of the House and Sistrum-Player of Amun-Re.*”⁵¹

The second generation is represented by Psammetik the Elder, *God’s Father* and *Priest of Montu, Khonsu, and Neferhotep*. His full titles are discussed above and listed in tables 1 and 3. His wife likewise bears the name Irtyru II. Birk proposed that Psammetik, the owner of the situla Cairo CG 3447, was the father of Nesmin.⁵² This suggestion, however, remains unproven, as the woman identified as the wife of Psammetik the Elder differs from the woman named as Nesmin’s mother on Nesmin’s own monuments. This discrepancy allows for two possibilities: either Psammetik the Elder had two marriages, or as argued here (see the genealogical chart in Table 3), the inscription refers to another Psammetik belonging to the same extended family (who is assumed to be the grandfather of Psammetik the Younger).

The third generation is represented by Sheshonk the Younger, who held the same titles as his father and grandfather. This Sheshonk is likely the key link to the later, well-attested generations of the family, as the name Sheshonk appears on two statues of his grandson Nesmin (Cairo JE 36714 and JE 37215), where he is identified as his grandfather.⁵³

The comparative analysis of the titles borne by Sheshonk the Elder, Psammetik the Elder, and Sheshonk the Younger demonstrates a close correspondence with those attested for the lineage of Nesmin (Tables 1 and 2). This shared official nomenclature includes relevant offices within the service of the Theban deities Montu, Khonsu, and Neferhotep.⁵⁴ Consequently, Psammetik the Elder is hypothesized not simply as a homonymous individual but as the progenitor of the family later documented by Nesmin’s multiple attestations. Considering this suggestion, the author asserts that the Cairo situla (CG 3447) provides the earliest secure documentation of this Theban priestly lineage, dating its origin to the late fourth century BCE. Furthermore, the situla, together with the monuments associated with the family of Nesmin, provide

⁵¹ iHj.t n Imn-Ra, ‘*Songstress of Amun-Re,*’ a priestly title which often designating female persons. It designates priestesses who served as musicians in the cults of Amunre or other deities. *Wb* I, 121.18; Jansen-Winkeln, *Biographische und religiöse Inschriften der Spätzeit*, II, 373 (c); Jansen-Winkeln, K., “Drei Statueninschriften einer Familie aus frühptolemäischer Zeit,” *SÄK* 36, 2007, 59, 61; Rashed, *The block statue of Djedhor*, 369-370.

⁵² Birk, *Türöffner des Himmels*, 208 n.318.

⁵³ Birk, *Türöffner des Himmels*, 495-496, 503.

⁵⁴ It is worth noting, however, that the absence of the title “*Priest of Wenennefer*” from the titles of both Nesmin and his sons somewhat weakens the proposed family connection. Given that this office appears prominently in the inscription of Psammetik the Elder, its absence from the later monuments of the latter’s family members, suggests either a discontinuity in the transmission of specific priestly functions within the family, or that the two lines may not, in fact, be directly related. This absence does not rule out the hypothesis entirely, but it serves as a reminder of the limits of the available evidence and the need for caution when reconstructing genealogical ties on the basis of titles alone.

evidence of the lineage's development across six generations, extending its activity into the early Ptolemaic Period.

However, since independent corroborating evidence is lacking, the proposed familial connections and the resulting genealogical structure (shown in Table 3) must be considered with caution. Accordingly, the proposed connection between Psammetik the Elder and Nesmin should be viewed as a plausible hypothesis, enhanced by the convergence of titles and cultic affiliations, rather than as an established fact.

4.2 The Writing Characteristics and Origin of the Inscription

The inscription recalls the ritual voice of the libation formula (PT Spell 32 (*Pyr.* 22-23), while maintains references to the family of Psammetik the Elder. The first section introduces the libation formula quoted from the Pyramid Texts, extended with the titles of Psammetik the Elder to whom the situla is dedicated. The final section in columns (9) to (13) serves as a dedicatory statement naming his son, Sheshonk the Younger.

The inscription reflects characteristics of the Late Period inscriptions from the Twenty-Sixth Dynasty to the Thirtieth Dynasty. The text is engraved in a good manner and is readable while showing several scribal features which can be taken as general observation of the period. Among the scribal remarks one can list the following:

- He dropped signs in the writing of several words as common mistakes in the inscriptions of this period.
- He was either not control the space dedicated to the inscription rightly otherwise he forget certain signs and had to add them as seen in the unbalanced size of certain signs. Compare for instance the size of the sign  in the name of Khonsu-in-Thebes-Neferhotep in comparison to the inscription in general. Again in the writing of  at the end of column (8).
- The scribe felt in several mistakes copying the original passage from PT Spell 32. The spell addresses the king as it variations in the PT state that, not Horus in the present case, a replacement with the deceased name is even more convincing for the current context. Thus, the scribe was confused in his copying for the text.

The inscription opens with the libation formula corresponding to the initial opening of Pyramid Text Spell 32 (*Pyr.* 22a–b), a text frequently attested from the Old Kingdom onward.⁵⁵ In its present version, the formula has been adapted to a Late Period

⁵⁵ The formula is well-known from the PT Spell 32–33 and its later middle kingdom version in the Coffin Texts Spell 64. Sethe, K., *Die altägyptischen Pyramidentexte*, vol. I, Leipzig/Berlin, 1908, spell 32–33; Faulkner, R. O., *The Ancient Egyptian Pyramid Texts: Translated into English*, I, Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1969, 6–7.

funerary context. Following the initial opening in columns (1–2), the spell continues in columns (4) and (8), where the libation is addressed to the deceased.

The cool-water libation formula appears widely in funerary and ritual scenes and is often reproduced with minor variations. The inscriptions on Late and Ptolemaic situlae constitute an important corpus for the study of these formulae, since selected quotations were revived and adapted to accompany scenes depicting the burning of incense and the offering of cool water.⁵⁶ Comparable examples occur on Late Period situlae, such as Cairo CG 3448 and CG 3450,⁵⁷ Louvre N 908 D, the British Museum EA 38212,⁵⁸ and Chicago (ISACM E11394).⁵⁹ This association between formulae and situlae as carriers of quotations derives from the ritual function of the vessels themselves, which were used for funerary and religious ceremonies, including decade feasts and funeral rites.⁶⁰ Bommas have argued that these vessels had become traditional implements for offering cool-water by the New Kingdom.⁶¹

4.3 Provenance and the Archaeological Context

The provenance of the situla remains a matter of scholarly debate. According to the *Journal d'entrée*, its provenance is Sheikh Abd el-Qurna, where this situla was listed together with three vases under the same entry (JE 15127–15130).⁶² The *Journal d'entrée* and accordingly the Museum's database records that these vases are dated to the Twenty-Second Dynasty and likewise assigned to Sheikh Abd el-Qurna,⁶³ though without clarifying whether they derived from a single tomb or shaft. Unfortunately, the *Journal d'entrée* includes no reference photographs or detailed descriptions of the three accompanying vases. In the absence of supporting documentation, it remains uncertain whether these objects formed part of the same burial assemblage or were associated with Psammetik the Elder. Moreover, the current location of these vases is recorded as “not located” within the museum's database. The absence of an excavation record, together with the inability to trace the other vases reportedly

⁵⁶ Given the limited surface available on situlae and the designated spaces reserved for inscriptions, scribes commonly employed abbreviated versions of these spells.

⁵⁷ Bissing, *Metallgefäße*, 11-17.

⁵⁸ Budka, J. et al., *The Family of Pa-di-amun-neb-nesut-tawy from Thebes (TT 414) Revisited: The Case Study of Kalutj / Nes-Khonsu (G108 + G137)* (Archaeopress Egyptology 42), Oxford: Archaeopress, 2022, 21-23.

⁵⁹ see Kafafy, M., “A Situla of *t3-b3k(t)-n-3stn* in the Institute for the Study of Ancient Cultures Museum - The University of Chicago ISACM E11394,” *SHEDET* 13, 2024, 184, 186.

⁶⁰ Evrard-Derriks, C., Quaegebeur, J., “La situle décorée de Nesnakhetiou au Musée Royal de Mariemont,” *Chronique d'Égypte* 54, Fasc. 107, 1979, 33, no. (3), 55; De Meulenaere, H., Bothmer, V., (1974), “Une statue thébaine de la fin de l'époque ptolémaïque,” *Zeitschrift für Ägyptische Sprache und Altertumskunde* 101, 1974, 110–111; Bommas, *Situlae and the Offering of Water*, 258-259; Abdelrahman, *The situla of Pa-di-Amun-neb-nesut-tawy*, 1-23.

⁶¹ Al-Aguizy, O., “Kahnaut macbad Madinet Habu fi al-‘aṣr al-Baṭlamī min khilāl al-wathā’iq al-dīmūṭiqiyya,” in: *Hommages à Fayza Haikal* (BdE 138), Cairo: IFAO, 2003, 3-5; Bommas, *Situlae and the Offering of Water*, 263-264.

⁶² According to the *Journal d'Entrée* pages 188-189 (JE 15127), and the museum's database.

⁶³ Cairo JE 15127-15130.

associated with the same entry (JE 15127–15130), has hindered attempts to reconstruct the original provenance of the situla. The unidentified location of these objects at the Museum prevents their examination as a potential assemblage, thereby limiting the possibility of confirming a shared archaeological context or burial.⁶⁴ Consequently, the reconstruction of the situla's provenance must primarily rely on an analysis of its inscriptions and typological features compared to parallels with secure provenance, rather than on archaeological context.

Alternative suggestions for its provenance have been proposed. Following the 1895 Museum Guide,⁶⁵ Bissing⁶⁶ suggested Zagazig as a possible provenance for the situla, an attribution later confidently accepted by Porter and Moss.⁶⁷ The conflict between these accounts point out the uncertainty surrounding the vessel's findspot. Nevertheless, the titles borne by the owner and his family offer far stronger support for a Theban sphere of activity, and thus a Theban provenance, than for an origin in the Delta. The titles of Psammetik the Elder and his family provide more convincing evidence. It states careers correspond closely with Theban clergy, serving the Theban gods Wenennefer, Montu, lord of Thebes, and Khonsu-in-Thebes-Neferhotep;⁶⁸ thus supporting a provenance in Thebes rather than in Zagazig.

Due to the absence of reliable archaeological records, the provenance of the situla can be approached through comparative analysis with parallel examples attributed to Thebes or Zagazig. It is noteworthy that only a limited number of parallels securely their provenance were identified as from Thebes are known, whereas no parallels have thus far been attributed to Zagazig.⁶⁹ This distribution may lend stronger support to a Theban provenance for the situla; however, the limited corpus of examples with known provenance necessitates caution before reaching definitive conclusions.

A few Theban examples from the Late Periods are also known,⁷⁰ including situla of Ânkhpakhéred (Louvre E 12658)⁷¹ and situla of Djedhor (Cairo JE 33468),⁷² both

⁶⁴ About the matter of objects listed as 'not located' at the Egyptian museum of Cairo, see: Rashed M. G., Quirke St., "Trouvés Dans le Même Tombeau": Find-groups Recorded in Journal d'Entrée Volume 1 of the Egyptian Museum, Cairo" *SHEDET* 12, 2024, 154-155, and 154-172.

⁶⁵ Maspero, G., *Catalogue du Musée*, Cairo, 1892, 127, no. 2848, and 118; *Catalogue du Musée*, 1895, no. 1077; Mariette, *Album du Musée de Boulaq*, pl. 21; Bissing, *Metallgefässe*, 9-10.

⁶⁶ Bissing, *Metallgefässe*, 9-11.

⁶⁷ PM IV, 34A.

⁶⁸ See the previous section "The inscriptions," see also. Birk, *Türöffner des Himmels*, 487.

⁶⁹ The author made efforts to investigate and analysis most of situlae with secure provenance dated to the Late Period, and especially to the Thirtieth Dynasty. The focus was given to the parallels to the situla under discussion.

⁷⁰ Earlier Theban examples are attested from the New Kingdom. The Egyptian Museum in Turin holds two situlae of Kha from his tomb at Deir el-Medina, accessioned under (Suppl. 8228 and Suppl. 8231). Russo, B., *Kha (TT 8) and his colleagues: the gift in his funerary equipment and related artefacts from western Thebes* (GHP Egyptology 18), London, 2012, 46-47, Pl. VI.

discovered in the necropolis of Dra Abu el-Naga and dated to the Thirtieth Dynasty. Another Thirtieth Dynasty situla attributed to Nesmin son of Psammetik (Louvre N 908 D).⁷³ Although its provenance is uncertain, the close genealogical and titular links of its owner to the Theban clergy strongly suggest a Theban origin.⁷⁴ Given the overlap in names and priestly offices, it is suggested that Psammetik the Elder, the owner of situla under discussion, has ties with Nesmin, the owner of the Louvre situla, reflecting the familial continuity of prominent Theban priestly lineages during the Thirtieth Dynasty.⁷⁵

The situla of Ânhpakhêred (Louvre E 12658)⁷⁶ perhaps provides the closest parallel to CG 3447. Both vessels belong to Lichtheim's Type I and share the same decorative program: a centrally arranged libation scene bordered by a star band above and inscriptional registers below. In both cases, the iconography is strikingly similar, depicting the owner seated on a lion-legged chair receiving the libation from his son, who stands opposite pouring water from a ewer over an offering table. The intervening hieroglyphic inscription, arranged in vertical columns, contains the familiar libation formula (PT 32), titles, and genealogy. The strong iconographic and textual correspondences confirm a common Theban workshop tradition of the period.⁷⁷

The same observations apply to the situla of Nesmin (Louvre N 908D)⁷⁸ and the situla of Djedhor (Cairo JE 33468).⁷⁹ All of these vessels share not only the overall decorative scheme and ritual formula but also specific features in the depiction of the donor and recipient figures, as well as the placement and style of the inscriptions.

⁷¹ Louvre Online Catalogue: <https://collections.louvre.fr/en/ark:/53355/cl010017030> (accessed 9-9-2025); for the inscription, see: Jansen-Winkel, *Inschriften der Spätzeit. Teil V*, Berlin, 2023, 724-5, n° 82.174.

⁷² PM I², 608; Northampton, *Reports on some excavations in the Theban Necropolis*, 17-18 [11], fig. 18.

⁷³ The Louvre Museum online Catalogue: <https://collections.louvre.fr/ark:/53355/cl010036230> (Accessed 25-8-2025); Coulon, *Les voies ouvertes à l'égyptologie*, 37-39, fig.1; Birk, *Türöffner des Himmels*, 208, 488.

⁷⁴ Personal investigation on the situla, its inscriptions together with other monuments attributed to its owner and his family.

⁷⁵ Rashed, *The Theophorous Statue of Pedeamunnebnestauti*, *JARCE* 61/1, 77–102.

⁷⁶ Budka, *The Family of Pa-di-amun-neb-nesut-tawy*, 14 n.61; Gombert-Meurice, F., Payraudeau, F. (eds.), *Servir les dieux d'Égypte: divines adoratrices, chanteuses et prêtres d'Amon à Thèbes*, Paris: Somogy/Musée de Grenoble, 2018, 224-225, cat. 113.

⁷⁷ Although the inscriptions of both situlae share the same context, the paleographical characteristics of the writing are quite different and thus suggesting different scribe.

⁷⁸ Coulon, *Les voies ouvertes à l'égyptologie*, 37-39, fig.1; Collombert, Ph., "Hout-sekhem et le septième nome de Haute Égypte II: les stèles tardives," *RdE* 48, 1997, 21 note 14; 22; Birk, *Türöffner des Himmels*, 208 note 318, 241 note 55, 488.

⁷⁹ PM I², 608. Situla Cairo JE 33468 dated to the Thirtieth Dynasty, and from Dra Abu el-Naga. Its provenance is securely established, as it was discovered in the necropolis of Dra Abu el-Naga in Western Thebes during the winter excavation season of 1898/1899. Northampton, *Reports on some excavations in the Theban Necropolis*, 17-18 [11], fig. 18.

Psammetik the Elder is shown performing the ritual of libation and burning incense, an identical depiction for the presenter with the same attitude, vest and offerings' equipment in hands is seen in the situlae Louvre N 908C.⁸⁰ These consistencies demonstrate a coherent Theban tradition of situlae type and decorative program in the Thirtieth Dynasty, with the situla under discussion fitting seamlessly within this corpus. These parallels strengthen the argument that the situla of Psammetik the Elder should be attributed to a Theban provenance and dated securely to the Thirtieth Dynasty, rather than the Ptolemaic Period.

The dating of the situla is less problematic than the questions surrounding its provenance and the potential familial connections of its owner. While the *Journal d'Entrée* assigns the vessel to the Twenty-Second Dynasty,⁸¹ Porter and Moss⁸² proposed a Ptolemaic date, reflecting long-standing uncertainty in scholarly opinion.⁸³ A closer examination of its artistic and epigraphic features, however, together with potential links to securely dated examples, provides a firmer basis for chronological assessment. The attribution to the Twenty-Second Dynasty in the *Journal d'Entrée* was most likely derived from its archaeological context, as the situla was recorded alongside three other vases under the same entry.⁸⁴ Yet, given the absence of surviving contextual information and the current inaccessibility of these associated objects, this dating cannot be independently verified. In contrast, the Ptolemaic attribution by Porter and Moss—and later accepted by other scholars—relies primarily on stylistic features rather than a detailed analysis of the inscriptions or a comparison with closely datable parallels or related monuments.⁸⁵

It is worth noting that several situlae that were generally attributed to the Ptolemaic Period are actually from the Thirtieth Dynasty or even earlier. Thorough epigraphic and stylistic investigation, the re-evaluations of parallels, such as Ānkhpkhéréd (Louvre E 12658), Djedhor (Cairo JE 33468), and Pakharkhonsu (Louvre N 908C), have firmly established their date to the Thirtieth Dynasty. Furthermore, the suggested familial connection with the family of Nesmin son of Psammetik who is dated between the beginnings to the middle of the Thirtieth Dynasty recommends dating Psammetik the Elder between 75 to 90 years earlier⁸⁶ adding three generations of this

⁸⁰ Gombert-Meurice, *Servir les dieux d'Égypte*, 224, note 5.

⁸¹ According to the Egyptian Museum registers: JE 15127, SR.2-13418, and the database.

⁸² PM IV, 34A; Bissing, *Metallgefäße*, 9-11.

⁸³ Birk, *Türöffner des Himmels*, 487.

⁸⁴ PM IV, 34A; Bissing, *Metallgefäße*, 9-11.

⁸⁵ Apart of the transcription of the inscription and the brief description by Bissing at the beginning of the Twenty century, this vessel had not been studied.

⁸⁶ This Nesmin lived during the reign of both Nectanebo I and II (the first half of the Thirtieth Dynasty, c. 380-343 BCE.) Thus, dating Psammetik the Elder—who goes back three generations before Nesmin—is possible through the estimation of the common length of generations. Taking in account that the generational interval is approximately 25–30 years based on previous scholarly estimations. Jansen-Winkeln, K., “The Relevance of Genealogical Information for Egyptian Chronology,” *Ägypten und Levante* 16, 2006, 257–273; Potter, *The Statue of a Sistrum-player*, 261–262.

family before Nesmin (see table 3),⁸⁷ and thus, Psammetik the Elder probably lived sometimes between the late Twenty-Sixth Dynasty to the very beginnings of the Thirtieth Dynasty. Additionally, the situla might be dedicated later to him by a son or a grandson, as a common tradition of the period. Given these new evaluations and the comparable features observed on (CG 3447), it is reasonable to propose a similar conclusion. In sum, the stylistic features of the vessel, the characteristics of its inscriptions, and the contextual parallels all indicate a dating within the Late Period, most convincingly to the beginning of the Thirtieth Dynasty or earlier.

5. Conclusion

The situla of Psammetik, son of Sheshonk (Cairo CG 3447), presents an example of late period ritual vessels. Through an integrated analysis of its characteristic features, decorative program, inscription, titles, and parallels, the study demonstrates that it securely belongs to the established Theban situla tradition of the Late Period. Despite conflicting early records and the loss of associated objects, the internal evidence strongly supports a Theban origin for the situla. Based on the documented offices and the implied familial ties of the owner, in conjunction with the similarities to the Theban parallels and those associated with Nesmin, a Theban origin can be established. Furthermore, these arguments, in conjunction with the suggestion of familial ties with Nesmin, son of Psammetik, strongly support a date between the Twenty-sixth and Thirtieth Dynasties.

The inscription enables the reconstruction of three generations of a Theban priestly family. When compared with the well-documented lineage of Nesmin, son of Psammetik, a strong correspondence is evident in both offices and cultic affiliations. Even though absolute identification remains tentative, it appears that Psammetik the Elder, owner of the present situla, represents an earlier generation of the same family, indicating that the roots of this lineage can be traced back to the late Twenty-Sixth to the beginning of the Thirtieth Dynasty. Accordingly, the Cairo situla (CG 3447) may constitute the earliest secure monument to this priestly family, attesting to its continuity over at least six generations.

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GENERATIONS AND FAMILIAL TIES	NAME	ATTESTED TITLES	ATTESTATIONS
			Objects type accession Number Bold = primary dedicator <i>Italic</i> = uncertain attestation
Generation 1	Sheshonk the Elder (<i>ššnk</i>) Grandfather	<i>Mi nn</i> (the same titles as his son Psammetik)	Situla Cairo CG 3447
	<i>Irturu I (wife)</i> <i>ʾr.t-ʾr.w</i>	<i>Nbt.-pr</i> <i>ʾhy.t n ʾImn-R^c</i>	Situla Cairo CG 3447
Generation 2	Psammetik the Elder (PsmTk) (owner)	<i>ḥm-nṯr</i> <i>ʾIt-nṯr ḥm-nṯr Wn</i> <i>ʾImi ʾbd.f</i> <i>ʾImi-ʾbd.f Ḥnsw-m-Wʾs.t</i> <i>Nfr-ḥtp ḥr sʾ tpi</i> <i>shʾw ḥtm.w-nṯr</i>	Situla Cairo CG 3447 * <i>statue Cairo JE</i> <i>37215 ; JE 36714</i> (A possible great- grandfather of Nesmin son of Psammetik)
	<i>Irturu II (wife)</i> <i>ʾr.t-ʾr.w</i>	<i>Nb.t-pr</i>	Situla Cairo CG 3447
Generation 3	Sheshonk the Elder (<i>ššnk</i>) (Son)	<i>ʾIt-nṯr; ḥm Wn</i> <i>Mi nn</i> (the same titles as his father and grandfather)	Situla Cairo CG 3447 * <i>statue Cairo JE</i> <i>37215; JE 36714</i> (A possible grandfather of Nesmin)
	<i>Unknown (wife)</i>	...	

Table (1): The genealogy and titles of Psammetik the Elder and his family as attested on situla (CG 3447).

The situla of Psammetik son of Sheshonk at the Egyptian Museum

NAME	ATTESTED TITLES	ATTESTATIONS Objects type accession Number Bold = primary dedicator
Psammetik the Elder, son of Sheshonk	<i>ḥm-nṯr; 'It-nṯr ḥm-nṯr; 'Imi-ḏbd.f ḥnsw m Wḏs.t Nfr-ḥtp ḥr sḏ tpī; shḏw ḥtm.w-nṯr; iri ps ḥr [ḥr] (sḏ) H.nw n Mnṯw nb Wḏs.t</i>	Situla Cairo CG 3447
Nesmin son of Psammetik the Younger	<i>'It-nṯr (ḥm)-nṯr 'Imn m 'Ipt-s.wt; shḏw ḥw.t-nṯr imi-ḏbd.f n pr- 'Imn ḥr sḏ H.nw n hrw T, Š; shḏw šn; shḏw pr.w-ḥd n Nfr-ḥtp n pḏ S sḏ.w (/shḏw pr.w-ḥd n Nfr-ḥtp n ḥw.t n pḏ S sḏ.w); shḏw tḏ; ḥm ḥd.t ḥm Hr wr Wḏd.ti</i>	Statue Cairo JE 37215 Statue Cairo JE 36714
	<i>ḥm-nṯr wr nḥt; ḥm shm s.t štḏ.t; ḥm-nṯr tpī ḥm H-nw Mnṯw nb Drw.t; ḥm-nṯr n ḥt.ḥr Nḥb.t nb r int; 'Imi-s.t-rd n 'Imn n sḏ H.nw; 'Imi-s.t-ḥ n pr 'Imn n sḏ H.nw; 'Imi-s.t-ḥ; Wḥb n 'Imn.t ḥri(.t)-ib 'Ip.t-s.wt; ḥm-nṯr tpī n Mnṯw nb Drw.t; ḥrp ḥm(.w) s.t štḏ(.t); 'Iri šn; 'Iri šn n hrw ḤŠ n pr Mw.t n sḏ S.nw nb ḥpr.f; 'Iri ps; 'Iri ḥft; ḥḏ wḥb; ḥḏ wḥb n tḏ ḥr.t(-ib) n pr 'Imn-(ip.t) ḥr sḏ H.nw; Rh nsw</i>	Louvre situla N 908 D Statue Cairo JE 37140 Statue Cairo JE 36715 Statue Cairo JE 37193

Table (2): The titular of Psammetik the Elder in comparison with these of his suggested grandson Nesmin.

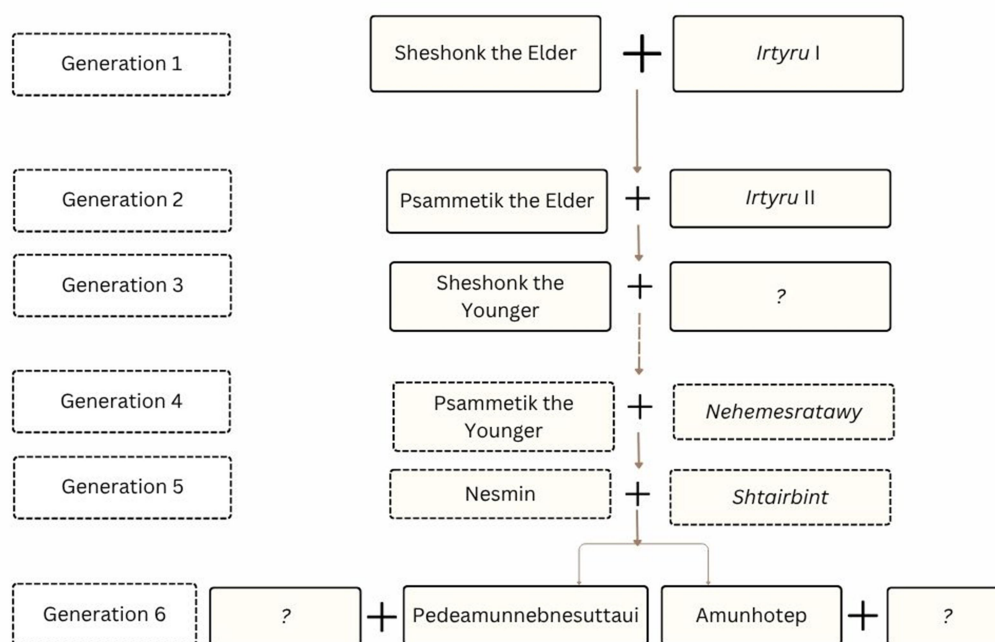


Table (3): Reconstruction of the Family Tree of Psammetik the Elder, son of Sheshonk the Elder. The owner is listed here as Psammetik the Elder; Female relatives are indicated in *italics*.



Fig. 1a: the situla of Psammetik son of Sheshonk the Elder (Cairo CG 3447). Courtesy of the Egyptian Museum in Cairo.

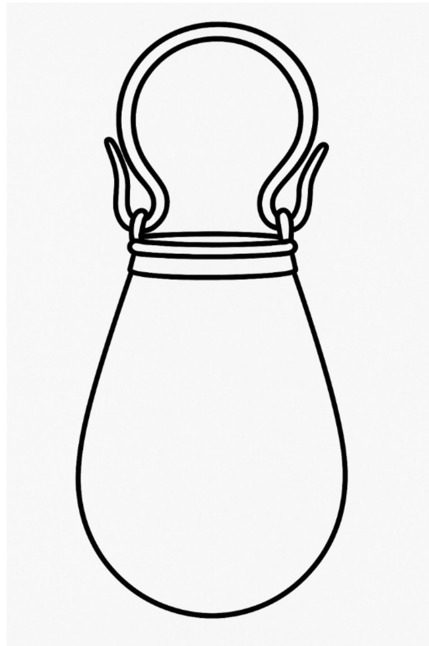


Fig. 1b: Outlined drawing of the situla of Psammetik son of Sheshonk (Cairo CG 3447). (@ the author).



Fig. 2: Psammetik the Elder seated and receiving the offering ritual from his son (Cairo CG 3447). Courtesy of the Egyptian Museum in Cairo.



Fig. 3: the central inscription between the figures of Psammetik the Elder and his son Sheshonk the Younger on the situla. Courtesy of the Egyptian Museum in Cairo.



Fig. 4: Sheshonk the Younger performs the cool water and censuring before his father Psammetik the Elder on the situla. Courtesy of the Egyptian Museum in Cairo.